

KCAC Advocacy Buddy — South Carolina

Advocate: Jane smith | Generated: 4/26/2026

Dear Representative,

H.4641 has a problem baked into its design: it treats two very different products as if they are the same thing. That is not public protection. That is a policy error with real consequences for real people, and there is a better path forward.

As a concerned citizen living in Colorado, I am urging you to weigh constituent testimony alongside headlines and talking points. My name is Jane Smith, and while South Carolina's legislation may feel distant geographically, the kratom community is national. Decisions made in your chamber ripple outward, setting precedent and shaping how other states approach this issue. That is why I am reaching out.

As someone who lives with this every day, I can tell you the reality is quite different from the headlines. Natural kratom products have been part of how I support my everyday comfort and maintain steady energy and focus. Taking that availability away would not make me safer. It would simply remove something that works for me, without addressing what is actually causing harm in the marketplace.

The thing causing the biggest damage right now is 7-OH, and that is what makes this so frustrating. If you go out and look at a natural kratom leaf on a tree, 7-OH is not sitting there in that growing leaf, so lawmakers should stop treating synthetic 7-OH like it is the same thing as natural kratom.

That distinction matters enormously from a regulatory standpoint. Synthetic 7-hydroxymitragynine is a lab-produced compound appearing in tablets, candies, and convenience-store products, items that have no connection to the traditional botanical. Lumping them together under one ban is like banning grapes because someone manufactured a dangerous synthetic alcohol. The source and the chemistry are not remotely comparable.

What South Carolina consumers actually need is straightforward: age restrictions, mandatory product testing, and honest labeling. That framework would address the real risks without stripping responsible adults of their right to choose a natural botanical supplement.

Please consider the difference between solving a problem and simply sounding tough on it. A ban on natural kratom may sound forceful, but focused regulation of synthetic 7-OH would be more effective, more accurate, and more just.

Respectfully,

Jane Smith

Colorado